of the eminent historian C. E. Bosworth (1928–2015), and those of the equally renowned and coeval anthropologist Fredrik Barth (1928–2016): Despite shared research geographies, the purely textual approach of the historian remained singularly unaffected by the on-the-ground, albeit modern findings of the anthropologist (and vice versa). Cf. *infra* in main text and Chapters 2–4.

25. Flood 2009: 91. This recent overall assessment of the Shansabanis has remained largely consistent beginning with Bosworth's scholarship of the 1960s, and extending through that of H. Edwards in the 1990s–2010s.
26. One of the major results of MJAP's efforts is, of course, Dr. Thomas' 2018 monograph, resulting from the only twenty-first-century archaeological work at Jam-Firuzkuh, from which the present book has benefited immensely. For the archaeo-botanical and -zoological analyses undertaken by MJAP, see, e.g., Thomas et al. 2006; and for ceramics esp. Gascoigne 2010 (*inter alia*).
27. Cf. Vasjutin 2003: 52; Mahmud 2009: 251–252; Elliott 2013: 5; Peacock 2015: 3ff. and notes. The idea of "barbarian" has, of course, derived from the seemingly parasitic raids on caravans and settlements by unindustrialized nomads. Bronson (1988) pointed out that "barbarians" possessed varying degrees of literacy and technological sophistication, and were considered "barbarians" simply because they lay *outside* a state's apparatus in terms of mobility and modes of production (i.e., varied and small-scale agricultural practices, "cottage" industries, sporadic and less taxable trading). Cf. also *infra* in main text and Chapter 1.
28. Cf. Thomas and Gascoigne 2016: 171–172. This premise is at variance with most previous studies, which assumed that "the population of the region [of Ghur] was largely sedentary, and had apparently been so since ancient times" (Habib 1992: 2). See also Bosworth 1961: 118, 133 n. 53. For the updated general characterization of the Shansabanis and their fellow Ghuris here, I rely on Thomas' monograph (2018, esp. pp. 3–10ff.). Cf. also Chapter 2.
29. Crossley 2019: xviii. Cf. also the work of the Collaborative Research Centre, "Difference and Integration," a joint project at the universities of Halle-Wittenberg and Leipzig: Büssow et al. (2011: 3) summarized the group's overarching "assumption that [nomads] follow rational choices no less than their sedentary counterparts … [for] example … preoccupation with the securing of pasture rather than an innate (and therefore irrational) lust for plunder [urging] the Turkic 'tribes' who had come to Anatolia in the eleventh century [to] head for the Caucasus."
30. Tracing the emergence of empires from nomadic or otherwise transhumant origins can be as fraught with preconceptions and generalizations as any other inquiry into large and multi-faceted socio-historical processes, underscoring the need for ongoing work to finesse more specific explanations. While anthropologists and historians have tended to favor some theories of state formation and the impetuses behind it, it is understood that no singular factor can explain the phenomenon among sedentist, nomadic, or in-between populations. For other overviews of favored theories of nomadic imperial formation, see Kradin 2003; also Crossley 2019.
31. Burbank and Cooper 2010: 9.